

of racing an F1 car around perfectly modelled real-world tracks. However, for someone picking up the controller for a racing game for the first time will not have much of an issue with racing and being competitive within the game thanks to the finely tuned assists. Damage can also be cosmetic (which will not affect the performance at all) or simulation where even minor damage can reduce performance.

F1 22 also has a couple of bonus racing options. In the Solo game tab, you have the option to quickly race any Grand Prix on the calendar. In that mode you can pick any team and driver you want. You can also keep the performance of the car realistic or equal for all. The other mode is Time Trials where you can just master a particular track and even compete in online rankings. You can also do entire Grand Prix's and Time Trials in Formula 2 cars which we highly recommend. F2 cars and teams are true to life as well with realistic performance. Lastly, there is the option to set some laps using supercars as well.

The DualSense controller on the PS5 adds a level of immersion that was previously unavailable to other controllers. For example, if you are a little too aggressive with the throttle and about to lose traction, the R2 trigger tightens up giving you the queue to back off a bit.

MOAR!

DEVELOPER

Codemasters

PUBLISHER

EA Sports

PLATFORMS

Microsoft Windows,
PlayStation 4,
PlayStation 5, Xbox
One, Xbox Series X/S

PLAYED ON

PlayStation 5

PRICE

₹2,999 (PC),
₹4499 (PS5)

F1 LIFE (WHY EVEN?)

Probably the weirdest part about the F1 22 game is F1 Life. In F1 Life you can deck up your quarters with fancy furniture, art, rugs, couches, lamps and even shove your supercar in there. You can also drape

your avatar in brand-ed clothing which is nice if you're into that sort of thing. And that virtual environment is where you can hang out with your online friends, cuz, you know that's what you want to do in a racing game, hang out in a virtual room.

GAME MODES

Most people looking to get the game will be interested in the career mode or multiplayer gaming.

The career mode in F1 22 has two options to choose from. The first is the My Driver Career mode and the other is the My Team Career mode. The My Driver career mode allows you to create a new driver to partner up with any of the team's existing drivers. You progress through the career as you normally would as a new driver with the current lineup of teams. You can research parts and upgrade them to yield better performance.

The My Team career mode though is much more interesting. With this mode, you get the chance to create a whole new team as the 11th team on the grid (just in case you didn't know, Formula 1 currently has only 10 teams). You have the option to choose how strong this new hypothetical team will be. The New-comer mode is the one we would go for as a challenge to reach the top over multiple seasons. It's like setting up a whole new team from scratch. The next mode is the Midfield Challenger. Here your research departments are already at a decent level and you have more resources and cash to play with. And the last mode is where you can start a new team that is already in the top echelons of the sport. You have more money available and the research facilities are the best in class.

Multiplayer mode has all the bells and whistles you might expect to get started with racing either your friends or random strangers online. The game also offers Weekly Events for a new challenge every week and you can test yourself



against everyone in Ranked Play. For local multiplayer F1 22 offers Split Screen and LAN Game options as well.

VERDICT

The newest iteration of the official F1 game rode the hype of this year's F1 season as there was a whole lot of stuff that was new to the sport. A new reigning world champion, brand new cars, new regulations and the maximum number of races in an F1 season to boot.

For the most part, the game brilliantly treads the line between being a full-on dashing car arcade game and a full-on super serious sim. It has pretty much everything an F1 fan would need from a game and it has most things a racing game fan would need from a game. Overall, it is a pretty enjoyable experience for sure.

But there are a few aspects where things could have been better. The game would be perfectly fine without the F1 Life. Instead of that, devs could have given us the option to buy and race legendary F1 cars from yester-years. Not only would that be more appreciated, but it would also give a casual racer a taste of the development that F1 cars have seen over the many decades of the sport. There is also the issue of the illusion of speed, which we must say is more of a personal gripe.

On the PS5 the game worked pretty flawlessly without any drops in frame rate (or at least ones that we noticed). The new DualSense controller is the best controller to experience racing games on. While obviously not as immersive as a feedback wheel and pedals, the DualSense controller gives a new dimension to racing at least with F1 22. *